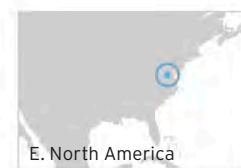


Monticello

A hilltop Palladian villa, designed according to Classical proportions by a future president of the United States



In 1768, aged just 26, the lawyer and politician Thomas Jefferson (1743–1826) inherited 8 square miles (20 square km) of land just outside Charlottesville, Virginia, from his father. He farmed the land (using slave labor) and, indulging his interest in architecture, drew the blueprints for a plantation house. He based his design on the principles of the Italian Renaissance architect Andrea Palladio (1508–1580).

Little mount

Jefferson lived in the house—named Monticello, from the Italian for “little mount”—from 1770; following the death of his wife Martha, he traveled to France in 1784, and in 1785 took the post of Minister to France. Inspired by the architecture he saw in Paris, he returned to the US with new plans for Monticello, which he remodeled and enlarged, adding a central octagonal dome and transforming the eight-room villa into a 21-room house in the Neo-Classical style. He lived in the house until his death in 1826, moving to Washington during his presidency (1801–1809).

▽ IMPRESSIVE ENTRANCE

Monticello has two main entrances. Visitors enter through one dominated by a columned portico, which leads into a domed reception room.



The White House

The official residence and workplace of the president of the United States



The Neo-Classical building at 1600 Pennsylvania Avenue in Washington, D.C., is perhaps the most famous structure in the world. Every president since John Adams in 1800 has lived in the White House, as it is popularly known.

President's residence

The residence was designed by James Hoban (1755–1831), who modeled it on Leinster House, Dublin. It was built between 1792 and 1800. The West Wing was added in 1901, and the famous Oval Office was created in 1909.

A myth has arisen that during the rebuilding of the mansion after the British sacked and burned Washington in 1814, white paint was used to mask the damage, hence its modern name. But the exterior had been coated with a lime-based whitewash to protect it from moisture and frost from as early as 1798.

▷ LOOKING DOWN

This photograph, taken from the top of the nearby Washington Monument, shows the modest size of the White House—the building is 168 ft (51m) long and 85 ft (26 m) wide.

